```
// index.php

session_set_cookie_params(['lifetime' => 3600]);
session_start();
```

```
$ curl -v http://localhost:8080/index.php
...
< Set-Cookie: PHPSESSID=<SESSION_ID>; expires=Thu, 17 Jul 2025 18:02:48
GMT; Max-Age=3600; path=/
...
```

Session Data

The way that PHP serializes session data is set with the `session.serialize_handler` ini directive, which is usually set as `session.serialize_handler = php` in most docker images/OS packages. This is very (very) similar to the serialization method that's used by PHP's `serialize()`/`unserialize()` functions. I'll use `serialize()` to demonstrate the principles, but bear in mind that the official PHP documentation states that the session default method is not identical. Obviously, you will not need to do your own serialization when using native PHP sessions because it's baked in. The following is presented purely for information and education purposes! With that in mind, place the following code in your `index.php` file…

```
// index.php
session_start();

$_SESSION['data'] = [
    'cat' => 'Jess',
    'humans' => [
        'Anna',
        'Paul'
    ]
];

var_dump(serialize($_SESSION['data']));
```

… we can compare the output of `serialize()`…